Diabetic Retinopathy Warnings Across GLP-1 Receptor Agonist Labels

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Regulatory Warnings and Labeling Updates

The prescribing information for semaglutide products (RYBELSUS®/OZEMPIC® tablets, OZEMPIC® injection, and WEGOVY®) includes a Warning and Precaution for diabetic retinopathy complications (Section 5.3) [d3.pdf p.3][d3.pdf p.1][d4.pdf p.1].

Clinical trial data (semaglutide injection): In a 2-year cardiovascular outcomes trial in patients with type 2 diabetes and high CV risk, adjudicated diabetic retinopathy complications occurred in 3.0% of patients receiving semaglutide injection versus 1.8% on placebo [d3.pdf p.3]. The absolute risk increase was greater in patients with a history of diabetic retinopathy at baseline (semaglutide 8.2%, placebo 5.2%) than in those without known history (semaglutide 0.7%, placebo 0.4%) [d3.pdf p.3].

Oral semaglutide (tablets): In pooled glycemic control trials, diabetic retinopathy adverse reactions were reported in 4.2% of patients on semaglutide tablets and 3.8% on comparator [d3.pdf p.3]. The effect of long-term glycemic control with RYBELSUS® and OZEMPIC® tablets on diabetic retinopathy complications has not been studied [d3.pdf p.3].

Mechanism noted: Rapid improvement in glucose control has been associated with a temporary worsening of diabetic retinopathy [d3.pdf p.3].

Monitoring recommendation: Patients with a history of diabetic retinopathy should be monitored for progression of diabetic retinopathy [d3.pdf p.3][d3.pdf p.1].

Patient counseling: Patients are advised to contact their physician if changes in vision are experienced during treatment [d3.pdf p.9].

The retrieved excerpts do not contain diabetic retinopathy labeling for other GLP-1 receptor agonists (e.g., liraglutide, dulaglutide, exenatide, lixisenatide, tirzepatide).

Sources

- [d3.pdf p.1]
- [d3.pdf p.3]
- [d3.pdf p.9]
- [d4.pdf p.1]

1/2 sections fully grounded.